STUDENT HANDOUT

YELLOW LEVEL
GRADE LEVEL

Why People Move: The Great Migration

Grades 5–8 · Social Studies

ADMIT ONE

NAME	DATE	CLASS

The Harlem Renaissance (c. 1920–1935) produced extraordinary work across every art form. It grew from the Great Migration and created a permanent shift in American culture — its influence is still felt in music, visual art, literature, and civil rights today.

01

ACTIVITY 1 · PRIMARY SOURCE ANALYSIS — SOAPS METHOD

Reading History Through Documents

Choose one primary source from the exhibition (a letter, photograph caption, or map annotation). Apply the SOAPS method:

ELEMENT	WHAT I FOUND / MY ANALYSIS
S — Speaker Who created this?	
O — Occasion When and why?	
A — Audience Who was it for?	
P — Purpose What was it trying to do?	
S — Subject What is it about?	

As historical evidence, this source is valuable because:

Its limitations as evidence are:

02

ACTIVITY 2 · CAUSE AND EFFECT CHAIN

How the Migration Led to the Renaissance

Complete the chain of causation below — each box should follow logically from the one before:

Jim Crow laws + racial violence in the South

↓

Effect 1: _____

↓

Effect 2: _____

↓

The Harlem Renaissance

03

ACTIVITY 3 · PARALLEL MIGRATIONS

Then and Now

Migration has always been part of human history. Choose one current or recent migration pattern and compare it to the Great Migration using the table:

	THE GREAT MIGRATION (1910–1940)	MIGRATION I CHOSE: _____
Push factors		
Pull factors		
Challenges faced		
Cultural impact		

The most important similarity between these two migrations is:

_____

_____

MINI MUSEUM CONNECTION

Option 1 — Visit the exhibition: If the Harlem Renaissance exhibition is available at your school, visit the Mini Museum to experience the phonograph, Jazz Lab, Great Migration Map, and more. Ask your librarian to arrange a class visit.

Option 2 — Virtual visit: minimuseumproject.org/exhibitions/harlem-renaissance

SHARE WITH YOUR FAMILY

Explore the Great Migration Map at **minimuseumproject.org/exhibitions/harlem-renaissance** with your family. Trace the journey together and discuss: where did your own family come from? What did they carry?